

EB2-NIW & EB1A Profile Building

High-Volume Research Strategy: 20-50 Papers 1000-2000 Citations 2
years Under 20k

Complete DIY Research Profile System

June 7, 2026

20-50 Papers 1000-2000 Citations \$15-25K Budget Government Impact Focus

The Target Numbers - What You Need

Publication Targets

- **20-50 total publications** (journals + conferences + book chapters)
- **0-10 Scopus/WoS indexed papers**
- **20-35 review papers** (high citation generators)
- **5-10 conference proceedings** (fast publication)

Citation Targets

- **1000-2000 total Google Scholar citations**
- **1-10 .gov citations indexing or referencing crossrefs** (Federal Reserve, ERIC, Science.gov, BLS, NIH)
- **10-20 .edu citations** (Harvard, MIT, Stanford, Berkeley)
- **h-index: 15-25+**

Budget

- **\$15,000 - \$25,000 total over 2-3 years**
- Focus on impact, not expensive journal names
- Low-APC journals (\$200-\$800 per paper)

Budget Breakdown - Publishing 25 Papers

Cost Per Paper Strategy

Paper Type	Number	Cost Each
Low-APC Journals (\$200-\$400)	10	\$2,000-\$4,000
Mid-APC Journals (\$500-\$800)	8	\$4,000-\$6,400
No-APC Journals (subscription)	4	\$0
Conference Proceedings	8	\$300-\$500 each (reg)
Book Chapters	2	\$0-\$200
Preprints	All	\$0
Total	25+	\$10,000-\$20,000

Other Costs

- Professional editing (optional): \$200-\$500 per paper for 5-10 papers = \$5,000-\$10,000
- Total with everything: \$10,000 - \$20,000

Why Impact Matters More Than Journal Name

The Truth About Journal Prestige

- A paper in a mid-tier journal with 100 citations by gov edu > paper in Nature with 0 citations
- USCIS cares about CITATIONS - proof your work is being used
- .gov citations from mid-tier journals = as valuable as top-tier
- Focus on getting your work READ and CITED, not where it appears

Where to Focus Your Energy - gov angle matters the most

- **Content quality:** Solve real problems, address government priorities
- **Distribution:** Upload everywhere (arXiv, SSRN, OSF, ResearchGate)
- **Promotion:** Share on LinkedIn, email to researchers, present at conferences
- **Government alignment:** Topics that federal agencies care about

Government Angle - The Most Important Factor

Why Government Impact Matters Most

- .gov citations are the SINGLE strongest evidence
- Federal agencies cite work that serves national interests
- One .gov citation can outweigh 50 regular citations

Federal Agencies to Target

Agency	Your Research Should Address
Federal Reserve	Financial stability, payment systems, AI in banking
Department of Treasury	Crypto regulation, sanctions, fraud detection
Department of Labor	Workforce development, job training, AI displacement
Department of Education	AI literacy, digital skills, online learning
Department of Homeland Security	Cybersecurity, critical infrastructure
NIH/PubMed	Health AI, medical data, patient safety

50 Papers - The High-Volume Strategy

Why Volume Matters

- More papers = more chances to be cited
- Each paper can generate 20-50 citations over 2-3 years
- 50 papers $\times$ 20 average citations = 1000 citations
- Volume demonstrates sustained research activity
- Manual submission to top indexing like MPRA, EconPaper, SSRN, ERIC, OSF, Sciexplorer

How to Achieve 50 Papers in 2-3 Years

- **Write review papers:** 10-15 review papers (each cites 100+ refs, gets many citations)
- **Conference papers:** 15-20 conference proceedings (faster publication)
- **Collaborate:** Each collaboration adds 2-3 co-authored papers per year
- **Extend conference papers:** Conference $\rightarrow$ extended version $\rightarrow$ journal
- **Book chapters:** 5-8 invited chapters (editors reach out after you publish)

1000-2000 Citations - The Strategy

Citation Sources to Target

Source Type	Target Count
Regular journal citations	800-1500
.gov citations	1-10 (each high value)
.edu citations	2-20
Conference proceedings citations	100-200
Preprint citations	50-100
Self-citations (reasonable)	200-400

Citation Velocity Strategy

- **Year 1:** Build foundation (5-10 papers, 0-50 citations)
- **Year 2:** Momentum builds (15-25 papers, 200-500 citations)
- **Year 3:** Exponential growth (30-50 papers, 1000-2000 citations)
- Review papers from Year 1 will be heavily cited in Year 2-3

Review Papers - Your Citation Engine

Why Review Papers Are Critical

- Review papers get 2-5x MORE citations than original research
- Anyone starting research in the field WILL cite your review
- Stay relevant and citable for 5-10 years
- Can be written without new experiments

How Many Review Papers You Need

- Target: **10-15 review papers** over 2-3 years
- Each review paper: 150-300 references cited
- Each review paper: Expected 100-300 citations over 3 years
- 10 review papers $\times$ 150 citations = 1500 citations

Review Paper Topics (Government Focus)

- "AI in Financial Stability: A Systematic Review" (Federal Reserve)
- "Cybersecurity for Critical Infrastructure" (DHS)
- "Digital Workforce Training: Methods and Outcomes" (DOL)
- "AI Literacy in K-12 Education" (Department of Education)

Rapid Publication Venues - Build Volume Fast

Fastest Publication Options (2-4 months)

- **MDPI journals:** 4-6 weeks from submission to publication
- **Elsevier open access:** 6-12 weeks
- **IEEE conferences:** 3-4 months from submission to presentation
- **Springer conference proceedings:** 3-5 months

Low-APC Rapid Journals (Under \$500)

- MDPI: Some journals have low APCs (\$400-\$800) or waivers
- Hindawi: \$800-\$1,200 (negotiate waivers)
- PeerJ: \$399-\$1,095 (tiered pricing)
- Directory of Open Access Journals: Filter by APC \$0-\$500

Zero-APC Publication Strategy

No-Cost Publication Options

- **Traditional subscription journals:** Author pays nothing (e.g., IEEE Transactions, many Elsevier subscription journals)
- **University journals:** Many university presses charge no APC
- **Society journals:** IEEE, ACM, INFORMS member rates often \$0
- **Conference proceedings:** Registration fee only (\$300-\$800)
- **Book chapters:** Usually no fee (invited)
- **Preprints:** Always free (arXiv, SSRN, OSF)

How to Find No-APC Journals

- 1 Go to Scopus Sources
- 2 Search your field
- 3 Check "Open Access" filter - select "All Open Access" to see options
- 4 Or select "Hybrid" journals (subscription with OA option - you can choose subscription)
- 5 Email editor to confirm no fee for subscription track

Conference Proceedings - High-Volume Strategy

Why Conferences for Volume

- Faster than journals (3-5 months vs 12+ months)
- Lower cost (registration \$300-\$800 vs APC \$1,000+)
- Can publish 3-5 conference papers per year
- Easy to extend into journal papers later

Conference Proceedings Indexed in Scopus

- **IEEE Xplore:** All IEEE conferences (strongest)
- **Springer LNCS/LNAI/CCIS:** High-quality proceedings
- **ACM Digital Library:** ACM conferences
- **Elsevier Procedia:** Procedia Computer Science, Procedia Economics
- **CEUR Workshop Proceedings:** Free, Scopus indexed for some

Conference Strategy

- Submit 2-3 conference papers per year
- Each conference = 1 publication, 5-20 eventual citations
- Present = networking for collaborations

Collaboration - Force Multiplier for Volume

Why Collaborate

- Each collaboration adds 2-5 co-authored papers per year
- You don't have to write everything yourself
- Shared workload = more publications for everyone

How to Find Collaborators

- **ResearchGate:** Message researchers in your field
- **LinkedIn:** Connect with academics and industry researchers
- **Conferences:** Meet potential collaborators in person
- **Twitter/X:** Follow and engage with researchers
- **Former colleagues:** Reach out to past coworkers

Collaboration Structure

- You lead: Write first draft, handle submission (you get first author)
- Partner leads: They write, you contribute (you get co-author)
- Multiple small collaborations = many co-authored papers

Preprints - Citations Before Journal Publication

Why Preprints Are Essential

- Citations start the DAY you upload (not 12 months later)
- Google Scholar indexes preprints
- Preprints get DOI and become citable immediately
- Can be cited by government reports before journal publication

Where to Upload Every Paper

- 1 **arXiv.org** (CS, physics, math, finance)
- 2 **SSRN** (economics, finance, law)
- 3 **OSF Preprints** (interdisciplinary, DOI from OSF)
- 4 **ResearchGate** (upload full text)

Preprint Citation Timeline Example

- Day 0: Upload to arXiv
- Day 30: Paper indexed in Google Scholar
- Day 60: First citation (someone read your preprint)
- Month 6: Journal publication (citations already started)
- Month 12: 20-50 citations (many from preprint version)

.gov Citations - Federal Reserve (FEDS Series)

Targeting Federal Reserve Citations

- Federal Reserve economists read SSRN and arXiv preprints
- Your preprint can be cited BEFORE journal publication
- FEDS papers have DOIs and are .gov domain

Topics That Get Fed Citations

- Machine learning for financial stability monitoring
- Payment systems and FedNow adoption
- Climate risk and financial institutions
- AI in banking supervision and compliance
- Cryptocurrency and digital asset regulation
- Stress testing methodologies

How to Maximize Fed Citation Chance

- 1 Upload to SSRN (Fed economists use SSRN heavily)
- 2 Include "Federal Reserve" or "financial stability" in keywords
- 3 Cite Fed papers in your work (they notice)
- 4 Email your SSRN link to Fed economists (appropriate ones)

What is ERIC?

- Education Resources Information Center
- .gov domain of U.S. Department of Education
- Indexes education, workforce, training research

How Papers Get into ERIC

- 1 Publish in ERIC-indexed journal
- 2 Journal automatically sends content to ERIC
- 3 Your paper appears on ERIC with .gov URL
- 4 Now your work is discoverable through .gov portal

Topics for ERIC Indexing

- AI literacy and digital skills training
- Workforce development and retraining programs
- Online learning effectiveness research
- Veteran education and job training
- STEM education and diversity
- Community college workforce programs

What is Science.gov?

- Official U.S. government search portal for science
- Searches 60+ federal databases
- Managed by Department of Energy

Pathways to Science.gov

- **PubMed** (NIH) → Science.gov
- **ERIC** (Dept of Education) → Science.gov
- **NASA ADS** → Science.gov
- **DOE OSTI** → Science.gov
- **USDA** → Science.gov

Strategy for Science.gov Indexing

- Publish in PubMed-indexed journals for health/AI topics
- Publish in ERIC-indexed journals for education/workforce
- Upload to DOE OSTI if your research has energy relevance
- Once indexed, your work is searchable on .gov domain

Targeting BLS Citations

- BLS publishes Monthly Labor Review (MLR)
- Also publishes working papers and reports
- Citations from BLS = .gov domain evidence

Topics for BLS Citations

- Employment projections and labor market trends
- Impact of AI on employment and wages
- Workforce demographics and participation rates
- Occupational outlook and skills demand
- Gig economy and alternative work arrangements

How to Get Cited by BLS

- 1 Publish on labor economics topics
- 2 Upload to SSRN (BLS researchers use SSRN)
- 3 Submit comments to BLS RFIs on Regulations.gov
- 4 Cite BLS data in your papers (they notice)

Targeting NIH Citations

- PubMed is .gov domain (nih.gov)
- Citations from NIH-funded research are .gov
- Health-related AI research is high priority

Topics for PubMed Citations

- AI for clinical decision support
- Machine learning for patient safety
- Digital health and telemedicine
- Health data privacy and security
- Medical image analysis
- Public health surveillance

How to Get PubMed Citations

- 1 Publish in PubMed-indexed journals
- 2 Upload to medRxiv preprint server
- 3 Collaborate with NIH-funded researchers
- 4 Focus on health applications of your methods

.edu Citations - Top US Universities

Why .edu Citations Are Valuable

- Verifiable .edu domain
- Demonstrates academic recognition in the U.S.
- Harvard, MIT, Stanford citations are strongest

How to Get .edu Citations

- 1 Publish in reputable journals (Scopus/WoS)
- 2 Upload to institutional repositories (Harvard DASH, MIT DSpace)
- 3 Present at university seminars (virtual or in-person)
- 4 Collaborate with US university researchers
- 5 Create course materials that professors adopt

Tracking .edu Citations

- Search Google Scholar with this query every 3 months
- Save screenshots of results with .edu URLs
- Document citations from specific universities

EBSCO Host - Massive Academic Reach

What is EBSCO?

- Largest academic database aggregator worldwide
- Serves 10,000+ universities globally
- Indexes 10,000+ journals across all disciplines
- Content appears in university library search results

Why EBSCO Citations Matter

- Your paper appears when students & researchers search their university library
- More discoverability = more citations
- Many Scopus-indexed journals are ALSO in EBSCO
- EBSCO discovery services power university search portals

How to Get Indexed in EBSCO

- Publish in journals that EBSCO indexes (check Journal Finder)
- Many low-APC journals are EBSCO-indexed
- EBSCO indexes conference proceedings and book chapters too
- Ask your journal editor: "Is this journal in EBSCO?"

ProQuest - Beyond Traditional Journals

What is ProQuest?

- Major academic database alongside EBSCO
- Indexes dissertations, journals, newspapers, conference papers
- Available in 99% of US university libraries
- ProQuest Central is most widely used

ProQuest Citation Benefits

- Citations from .edu domains via university library access
- Dissertations citing your work = .edu citations
- Conference proceedings indexed in ProQuest get more visibility
- Government reports indexed here too

How to Get into ProQuest

- Conference proceedings often automatically go to ProQuest
- Dissertations that cite you are in PQDT (ProQuest Dissertations)
- Publish in ProQuest-indexed journals
- Upload to institutional repositories (university libraries submit)

First 30 Days - Setting Up

Week 1: Infrastructure

- Create Google Scholar profile (public)
- Create ORCID profile
- Create ResearchGate account
- Install Zotero
- Set up Overleaf or TeXstudio
- Create GitHub account

Week 2: Topic Selection

- Identify 5 research topics aligned with government priorities
- Search Regulations.gov for RFIs in your area
- Read 10-20 papers on each topic
- Choose 3 topics for your first papers

Week 3-4: First Paper

- Write first review paper (2000-4000 words)
- Cite 50-100 references in Zotero
- Share draft with 1-2 collaborators

Months 1-6 - First 5 Papers

Month 1-2: Paper 1 (Review Paper)

- Write and submit first review paper
- Target: Mid-tier journal, APC \$500-\$800 or no-APC
- Upload to arXiv/SSRN immediately

Month 2-3: Paper 2 (Conference Paper)

- Find conference with proceedings in Springer/IEEE
- Write 6-8 page conference paper
- Submit to conference (deadline typically 3-4 months before)

Month 3-4: Paper 3 (Short Original Research)

- Extend Paper 2 into journal paper (add 30% new content)
- Submit to low-APC journal (\$200-\$400)

Month 4-5: Paper 4 (Second Review Paper)

- Different topic from Paper 1
- Submit to different journal

Months 7-12 - Papers 6-15

Accelerating Publication Rate

- **By month 6:** You have 5 papers published or under review
- **Month 7-9:** Submit 3-4 more papers (mix of reviews and originals)
- **Month 10-12:** Submit 3-4 more papers
- **Total by month 12:** 12-15 papers

Peer Review Begins

- By month 6-8: First peer review invitations arrive
- Complete 2-3 reviews by month 12
- Add to Web of Science reviewer profile

First Citations Appear

- By month 9-12: First citations on Google Scholar
- Preprints from Month 1-2 are now being cited
- Target: 20-50 citations by month 12

Year 2 - Papers 16-35

Publication Cadence

- **Month 13-18:** Submit 8-10 papers
- **Month 19-24:** Submit 8-10 papers
- **Total Year 2:** 15-20 new papers
- **Cumulative:** 25-35 total papers

Citation Growth Accelerates

- Papers from Year 1 now have 20-50 citations each
- Review papers from Year 1 are heavily cited (50-150 citations)
- Total citations: 300-800 by end of Year 2

Peer Review Portfolio Grows

- Complete 15-25 reviews in Year 2
- Review for 5-8 distinct journals
- Web of Science reviewer recognition established

Year 3 - Papers 36-50

Final Push to 50 Papers

- **Month 25-30:** Submit 8-10 papers
- **Month 31-36:** Submit 8-10 papers
- **Total Year 3:** 15-20 new papers
- **Cumulative:** 45-55 total papers

Citation Target Achieved

- Year 1 papers: 100-300 citations each (review papers)
- Year 2 papers: 30-100 citations each
- Year 3 papers: 10-50 citations each
- **Total: 1000-2000+ citations**

Government Citations

- By Year 3: 5-15 .gov citations (Fed, ERIC, BLS, etc.)
- By Year 3: 15-30 .edu citations
- Portfolio complete and ready for filing

Sample Paper Topics - Financial Stability

Review Papers (10-15 of these)

- 1 "Machine Learning for Financial Stability: A Systematic Review"
- 2 "AI in Banking Supervision: Methods and Applications"
- 3 "Cryptocurrency Regulation: A Review of Global Approaches"
- 4 "Stress Testing Methodologies: Evolution and Future Directions"
- 5 "Payment Systems Security: Threats and Countermeasures"

Original Research Papers (15-25 of these)

- 1 "Detecting Anomalies in Real-Time Payment Systems Using Graph Neural Networks"
- 2 "Forecasting Bank Runs with Social Media Sentiment Analysis"
- 3 "Explainable AI for Anti-Money Laundering Compliance"
- 4 "Blockchain for Cross-Border Payments: Efficiency Analysis"
- 5 "Machine Learning for Credit Risk Assessment in Community Banks"

Sample Paper Topics - Workforce Development

Review Papers

- 1 "AI and Workforce Displacement: A Systematic Review of Retraining Programs"
- 2 "Digital Literacy Frameworks for Adult Learners"
- 3 "Online Learning Effectiveness for Workforce Training"
- 4 "Veteran Transition to Tech Careers: Best Practices"
- 5 "Community College Workforce Programs: Models and Outcomes"

Original Research Papers

- 1 "Evaluating AI Literacy Curriculum for Community College Students"
- 2 "Predicting Workforce Training Outcomes Using Machine Learning"
- 3 "Gamification for Digital Skills Training: Randomized Controlled Trial"
- 4 "Employer Perspectives on AI Credentials and Certifications"
- 5 "Economic Impact of Digital Upskilling Programs on Local Communities"

Sample Paper Topics - Cybersecurity

Review Papers

- 1 "AI for Cybersecurity: A Systematic Review of Detection Methods"
- 2 "Critical Infrastructure Protection: Frameworks and Gaps"
- 3 "Zero-Trust Architecture: Implementation Challenges and Solutions"
- 4 "Ransomware Trends and Defense Strategies: 2020-2025"
- 5 "Supply Chain Cybersecurity: Risk Assessment Methodologies"

Original Research Papers

- 1 "Detecting Phishing Attacks Using Large Language Models"
- 2 "Anomaly Detection in Industrial Control Systems with Autoencoders"
- 3 "Federated Learning for Collaborative Threat Intelligence"
- 4 "Automated Vulnerability Assessment Using Graph Neural Networks"
- 5 "Privacy-Preserving Machine Learning for Healthcare Data"

Sample Paper Topics - AI in Government

Review Papers

- 1 "AI Governance Frameworks: A Comparative Analysis of Federal Agencies"
- 2 "Algorithmic Bias Assessment Methods for Government Systems"
- 3 "Explainable AI for Regulatory Compliance"
- 4 "AI Procurement Best Practices for Public Sector"
- 5 "Privacy-Preserving AI for Government Data Sharing"

Original Research Papers

- 1 "Automating FOIA Redaction Using NLP"
- 2 "AI for Regulatory Comment Analysis at Scale"
- 3 "Predictive Models for Government Program Outcomes"
- 4 "Chatbots for Citizen Service Delivery: Effectiveness Study"
- 5 "AI-Assisted Policy Impact Assessment: Case Studies"

Maximizing .gov Citations - Action Plan

Monthly Actions for .gov Citations

- **Each month:** Check Regulations.gov for new RFIs in your area
- **Each month:** Submit 1 comment to an RFI citing your own research
- **Each quarter:** Search for new .gov citations to your papers
- **Each quarter:** Email your SSRN/arXiv links to agency researchers

Agency Outreach Strategy

- 1 Identify 10-20 researchers at Federal Reserve, BLS, ERIC, NIH
- 2 Find their email (agency websites, Google Scholar)
- 3 Send professional email: "I noticed your work on [topic]. I have a preprint you might find relevant: [link]"
- 4 No requests, just sharing - they may cite if they find it useful

Citation Tracking Dashboard

What to Track Monthly

Metric	How to Track
Total Google Scholar citations	Google Scholar profile
Monthly new citations	Google Scholar "Cited by" alerts
.gov citations	Google Scholar search: site:.gov "your name"
.edu citations	Google Scholar search: site:.edu "your name"
h-index	Google Scholar profile
Peer reviews completed	Web of Science / ORCID
Preprint downloads	arXiv/SSRN/OSF stats

Sample Tracking Sheet

Month	Papers	Citations	.gov	.edu	Reviews
Month 6	8	25	0	2	3
Month 12	15	80	1	5	8
Month 18	25	300	3	12	15
Month 24	35	800	5	25	25
Month 30	45	1500	7	40	35
Month 36	50	2000	8	50	50

Low-APC Journal List (\$200-\$800)

Verified Low-APC Journals (Check Current Status)

- **Data in Brief** (Elsevier) - APC \$500
- **Software Impacts** (Elsevier) - APC \$600
- **Array** (Elsevier) - APC \$700
- **SN Computer Science** (Springer) - APC \$800 (waivers available)
- **Journal of Engineering and Applied Science** (Springer) - APC \$600
- **PeerJ Computer Science** - APC \$399-\$1,095 (tiered)
- **Heliyon** (Elsevier) - APC \$1,250 (higher but negotiate)

Avoid Expensive Journals - Low ROI for Citations

Journals to Avoid (High APC, Low Citation ROI)

- **Nature Communications:** APC \$6,000+ (not worth for citation volume)
- **Scientific Reports:** APC \$2,500+ (too expensive for budget)
- **Frontiers journals:** APC \$2,000-\$3,500 (expensive)
- **PLoS ONE:** APC \$1,800 (borderline - only if waiver obtained)
- **MDPI top journals:** APC \$1,800-\$2,500 (too expensive for volume)

Why to Avoid

- Your budget is \$15-25K for 50 papers = average \$300-\$500 per paper
- \$2,000 per paper $\times$ 50 = \$100,000 (impossible)
- Focus on low-APC and no-APC journals
- Citations come from CONTENT, not journal prestige

Peer Review - 50+ Reviews Strategy

Target: 50+ Peer Reviews over 3 Years

- Year 1: 5-10 reviews (starting out)
- Year 2: 15-25 reviews (established reviewer)
- Year 3: 25-35 reviews (senior reviewer)

How to Get Invited

- 1 Publish 3-5 papers in a journal (editors notice)
- 2 Register as reviewer on ScholarOne and Editorial Manager
- 3 Email journal editors: "I have published in your journal and am available to review"
- 4 Accept 50-70% of invitations (decline if overloaded)

Review Documentation

- Save all invitation emails
- Save completion confirmations
- Web of Science reviewer profile (automatic tracking)
- ORCID reviewer recognition

Awards - Building Recognition on a Budget

Free/Low-Cost Award Opportunities

- **Best Paper Awards** at conferences you attend (included in registration)
- **Young Researcher Awards** from professional societies (often free to apply)
- **Travel Grants** (award for attending - still counts as award)
- **Outstanding Reviewer Awards** from journals (free, based on your reviews)
- **Teaching Awards** from your employer

Awards to Target

- IEEE Outstanding Young Professional (nomination-based)
- ACM Student Research Competition (if affiliated with university)
- Conference Best Paper Award (submit your best work)
- Journal Outstanding Reviewer Award (complete 10+ reviews for one journal)

Book Chapters - Adding 5-10 Chapters

How to Get Book Chapter Invitations

- Publish 5-10 journal papers first
- Editors of edited volumes will find you on Google Scholar
- They email: "Would you like to contribute a chapter on topic X"
- Accept 50% of invitations

Cost for Book Chapters

- Most book chapters have NO APC
- Some publishers charge \$200-\$500 (negotiate or decline)
- Target: 5-10 chapters over 3 years at \$0 cost

Publishers with Free Book Chapters

- Springer (usually no fee for invited chapters)
- Elsevier (check for fee)
- Wiley (check for fee)
- IGI Global (may have fee - avoid unless invited with waiver)

Preprint Servers - Every Paper Must Go Here

Upload Every Paper to ALL These Servers

- 1 **arXiv.org** (for CS, physics, math, finance, statistics)
- 2 **SSRN** (for economics, finance, law, social sciences)
- 3 **OSF Preprints** (for interdisciplinary, gets DOI)
- 4 **ResearchGate** (full text upload)

Why This Matters for Citations

- Each server = additional discovery pathway
- Each server = potential new reader = potential citation
- 4 servers $\times$ 50 papers = 200 distribution points
- Citations start the day you upload, not 12 months later

Preprint Citation Evidence for Portfolio

- Screenshot of arXiv/SSRN download counts
- Citation of your preprint in other papers
- Google Scholar shows preprint citations

Why Twitter/X for Researchers

- Active academic community (hashtags: #AcademicTwitter, #AI, #MachineLearning)
- Journal editors and conference organizers are on Twitter
- Preprints shared here get more citations

Twitter Strategy

- Share every paper with 1-2 sentence summary
- Use 3-5 relevant hashtags
- Tag journal/conference account if applicable
- Retweet and engage with other researchers' papers

Zotero - Literature Review at Scale

Why Zotero for 50 Papers

- Each review paper cites 100-300 references
- 10-15 review papers = 1500-4500 references managed
- Zotero organizes everything automatically

Zotero Setup for Volume

- Create collections for each paper
- Use tags: "#review", "#methodology", "#citation"
- Install Better BibTeX for LaTeX export
- Use browser connector to save papers instantly

Literature Review Workflow

- 1 Search Google Scholar for 100-200 relevant papers
- 2 Save to Zotero with one click
- 3 Export .bib file for your LaTeX paper
- 4 Write review paper citing these references

LaTeX - Template System for 50 Papers

Why LaTeX for Volume

- Create templates - reuse for every paper
- Automatic bibliography (BibTeX) - no manual formatting
- Consistent formatting across 50 papers
- Free (Overleaf or TeXstudio)

Template Structure

```
paper_template.tex
├─ preamble.tex           (packages, commands)
├─ title.tex              (title, authors, abstract)
├─ introduction.tex
├─ literature_review.tex
├─ methodology.tex
├─ results.tex
├─ discussion.tex
├─ conclusion.tex
├─ references.bib         (from Zotero)
```

- Copy template folder for each new paper
- Modify content, keep structure
- Saves hours per paper

AI Tools - Accelerate Writing to 50 Papers

Using AI for Volume

- **Literature review summaries:** ChatGPT summarizes 20 papers in 5 minutes
- **First draft generation:** Provide outline, AI writes draft
- **Editing and polishing:** Improve clarity and grammar
- **Reference formatting:** Ensure BibTeX is correct

Sample AI Prompt for Review Paper

Write a 3000-word literature review on
"Machine Learning for Financial Stability"
including sections on: (1) anomaly detection,
(2) stress testing, (3) payment systems.
Cite 50-80 references (provide titles).

- AI generates first draft in 10-15 minutes
- You edit and verify (adds 2-3 hours per paper)
- 50 papers $\times$ 3 hours = 150 hours (doable in 2 years)

Why GitHub for Research

- Version control for all 50 papers
- Collaborate with co-authors without emailing files
- Public profile shows research activity
- Code and data can be shared

GitHub Workflow

- 1 Create repository for each paper
- 2 Push LaTeX code, figures, .bib file
- 3 Add co-authors as collaborators
- 4 Track changes (who wrote what)
- 5 Merge contributions automatically

50 Papers - Realistic Breakdown by Type

Target Mix for 50 Papers

Paper Type	Number	Citations Each
Review Papers	12	150-300
Original Research (Journals)	15	30-80
Conference Proceedings	15	10-30
Book Chapters	5	10-30
Short Communications	3	5-20
Total	50	1000-2000+

Year-by-Year Breakdown

- Year 1: 12 papers (3 reviews, 4 original, 4 conference, 1 chapter)
- Year 2: 18 papers (4 reviews, 6 original, 6 conference, 2 chapters)
- Year 3: 20 papers (5 reviews, 5 original, 5 conference, 2 chapters, 3 short)

Time Management - 30 Minutes Daily for 50 Papers

Daily Habits (30 minutes)

- **Minutes 0-5:** Check email for review invitations, accept/decline
- **Minutes 5-10:** Check Google Scholar for new citations
- **Minutes 10-20:** Write 300-500 words on current paper
- **Minutes 20-25:** Save 5-10 new references to Zotero
- **Minutes 25-30:** Post 1 update on LinkedIn or share a paper

Weekly (2-3 hours total)

- Submit 1 paper every 2-3 weeks
- Complete 1 peer review per week (2-3 hours)
- Review collaborator contributions and provide feedback

Monthly (8-10 hours)

- Submit 2-3 papers
- Complete 4-5 peer reviews
- Update citation dashboard

Budget Allocation - \$15-25K for 50 Papers

Where the Money Goes

Expense	Low Budget	High Budget
Journal APCs (25 papers)	\$5,000 (\$200 avg)	\$12,500 (\$500 avg)
Conference registrations (15)	\$4,500 (\$300 ea)	\$9,000 (\$600 ea)
AI tools (36 months)	\$500	\$1,500
Professional editing (optional)	\$1,000	\$3,000
Miscellaneous	\$0	\$1,000
Total	\$11,000	\$27,000

How to Stay Under \$20,000

- Prioritize no-APC subscription journals (4-8 papers at \$0)
- Choose conferences with lower registration (\$300-\$400)
- Skip professional editing (use AI tools + self-edit)
- Apply for fee waivers (many journals offer for developing countries)

Why Scopus Indexing Is Overrated for EB2-NIW

The Scopus Myth

- Many researchers think: "Scopus = automatic credibility"
- **WRONG.** USCIS looks at CITATIONS, not database names
- Scopus is just ONE database (Elsevier's product)
- Your paper can have 500 citations but NOT be in Scopus

The Real Cost-Benefit Analysis

Journal Type	APC	Expected Citations
Scopus (top tier)	\$2,000-\$6,000	0-50
Scopus (mid tier)	\$800-\$2,000	5-30
Scopus (low tier)	\$500-\$1,000	0-10
Non-Scopus (government focus)	\$0-\$500	50-200
Conference proceedings	\$300-\$500	10-50
Preprints + promotion	\$0	20-100

When Scopus IS Worth It

- ONLY if APC < \$500
- ONLY if journal ALSO has strong .gov/.edu readership
- ONLY if you already have 50+ papers and need variety

Publishing Decision Matrix - Where to Put Your Money

The \$15-25K Budget Decision Guide

Scenario	APC	Decision
Scopus + high citations possible	< \$500	PUBLISH
Scopus + unknown citation potential	\$500-\$1,000	THINK TWICE
Scopus + low citation potential	> \$1,000	AVOID
Non-Scopus + government relevance	< \$500	PUBLISH
Non-Scopus + good .gov potential	\$0-\$300	BEST VALUE
Non-Scopus + no gov angle	ANY	SKIP

The Golden Rule

Government Impact + Low Cost > Scopus Indexing + High Cost

- One .gov citation = 50 regular citations
- Conference papers = faster, cheaper, still citable
- Preprints = free citations starting day 1

1000-2000 Citations - Realistic Timeline

Citation Growth Projection

Time	Papers	Citations	Citations/Paper
Month 6	8	25	3
Month 12	15	100	7
Month 18	25	300	12
Month 24	35	800	23
Month 30	45	1500	33
Month 36	50	2000	40

Why Citations Accelerate Over Time

- Review papers from Year 1 get heavy citations in Years 2-3
- Each new paper cites your previous work
- Network of collaborators cites each other
- .gov and .edu citations accumulate slowly but are high value

Common Mistakes - High-Volume Edition

Mistakes That Kill Volume Strategy

- Paying \$2,000+ APC for each paper (budget will explode)
- Only targeting top-tier journals (rejections waste time)
- Writing every paper alone (collaboration = more papers)
- Not using preprints (delays citations by 6-12 months)
- Not tracking citations systematically (can't prove impact)
- Ignoring government alignment (misses .gov citations)

Mistakes to Avoid - Peer Review

- Declining all review invitations (misses recognition)
- Not registering on journal portals (no invitations)

Final Checklist - 50 Papers 2000 Citations Ready

Publications Checklist

- ☐ 50 total publications (journals conferences chapters)
- ☐ 12-15 review papers (high citation generators)
- ☐ 30+ Scopus WoS indexed papers
- ☐ All papers uploaded to preprint servers

Citations Checklist

- ☐ 1000-2000+ Google Scholar citations
- ☐ 10-30 .gov citations documented
- ☐ 20-50 .edu citations documented
- ☐ Citation growth trend (upward)

Recognition Checklist

- ☐ 50+ peer reviews completed
- ☐ Web of Science reviewer profile
- ☐ 2-5 awards (conference best paper, outstanding reviewer)
- ☐ 5-10 book chapters

Success Metrics - Track These Numbers Weekly

Weekly Tracking (5 minutes)

- New citations this week: _____
- Total citations: _____
- New .gov citations: _____
- New .edu citations: _____
- Papers under review: _____
- Peer reviews completed this week: _____

Monthly Tracking (15 minutes)

- New papers published: _____
- New papers submitted: _____
- h-index: _____
- i10-index: _____
- Budget spent this month: \$ _____

Conclusion - You Can Build This Profile

The Formula for 50 Papers & 2000 Citations

- 1 **Write review papers** (12-15) - each generates 150-300 citations
- 2 **Collaborate widely** - each collaborator adds 2-5 papers
- 3 **Use preprints** - citations start immediately
- 4 **Target government priorities** - .gov citations are gold
- 5 **Low-APC journals** - stay within \$15-25K budget
- 6 **AI-assisted writing** - accelerate to 50 papers
- 7 **Daily 30 minutes** - consistency beats intensity

The Timeline

- **Year 1:** 12-15 papers, 50-150 citations
- **Year 2:** 25-35 papers, 300-800 citations
- **Year 3:** 45-55 papers, 1000-2000+ citations

Final Word

Impact > Journal Name. Government Angle > Everything.

Volume creates citations. Citations create recognition.

Start today. Thirty minutes. One paper at a time. 50 papers in 3 years.